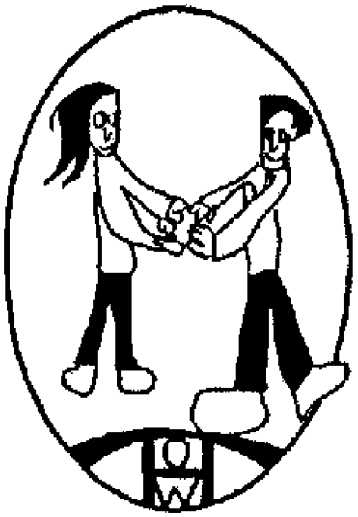
Howbridge Infant School



Anti-Bullying Policy

September 2025

Anti-Bullying Policy 2025

At Howbridge Infant School we believe that pupils should learn in a supportive, caring and safe environment without fear of being bullied. Bullying is an anti-social behaviour and can affect everyone; it is unacceptable and will not be tolerated. As a school we strive to promote equality of opportunity – challenging stereotypes, opposing prejudice, and respecting individuals regardless of age, gender, looked after status, disability, colour, race, ethnicity, class, religion, marital status or sexual orientation. When issues of bullying are addressed pupils will be able to fully benefit from the opportunities in school.

Bullying is when an individual or group deliberately hurts another individual or group repeatedly over a period of time. This may include:

- Verbal behaviour such as name calling and teasing
- Physical behaviour such as pushing, hitting or kicking
- Threatening behaviour
- Taking or breaking others belongings
- Excluding individuals from group activities

This policy applies to all members of the school community and we understand that bullying may occur in any of the following scenarios;

- Pupil to pupil
- Staff to pupil
- Staff to staff
- Pupil to staff
- Parent to pupil
- Parent to staff
- Staff to parent

When perceived bullying is reported it is important to ascertain the level of hurt experienced by the targeted person (victim). Vigilance on the part of staff, parents and pupils is necessary for identifying potential bullying that may not have been reported. This could be indicated by distinctive or inexplicable changes in behaviour.

The whole school community works together to create an ethos where bullying is not acceptable, therefore:

- Staff including support staff and midday assistants receive appropriate training
- Parental awareness is raised through regular school communications. Parents are informed of helpful websites and other resources in school.
- Pupils are consulted via the School Council and E-Safety Committee. Pupil awareness is raised through assemblies, PSHE lessons (including the Jigsaw Programme), our core values and circle time, Anti-Bullying Week, drama, social skills development, etc., as well as rewards and praise for good/kind/supportive behaviour. Pupils are helped to choose suitable playmates and safe activities.

This makes our school a safe environment where young people can learn and play happily and can talk about their worries with confidence that an adult will listen and offer help.

As adults we will always treat others with respect and recognise the rights of individuals:

1. To be listened to when they are in difficulty
2. To sensitivity and privacy

The children in our school will recognise the rights of others to be safe, to keep their own belongings, to be spoken to politely, to mix freely with their friends and others.

Where an incident of bullying has been identified the school will intervene with the aim of making the targeted individual feel safe and to encourage better behaviour from the perpetrator(s), colluders and observers. The school will follow the 'Support Team Approach' and this is a synopsis of the steps that will take place.

1. The targeted person will have the opportunity to discuss how they feel with a responsible person in the school. They will be asked to record their feelings in some form. This may be a picture or a piece of writing. They will be asked for the names of the persons involved in the bullying, the names of any colluders or observers and the names of some friends.
2. The responsible person will become a facilitator and will arrange a meeting with a balanced group of people (usually from the targeted person's list of names) in order that helpful and reliable people are included with those who have been causing distress.
3. The facilitator will explain to the group that he/she has a problem and is concerned about a person who is having a hard time at the moment using the picture of the writing to illustrate the person's feelings. **No details or blame are allocated.**
4. The facilitator will state that no-one is in trouble, they are all there to help solve the problem.
5. The group is asked for their ideas of what they could do to make the person <u>feel</u> better. Each person picks an idea to follow through and these are recorded for monitoring purposes.
6. The facilitator will thank the group (support team) and arrange a further meeting to see how things are going.
7. A few days later the facilitator will discuss how things are going for the targeted person and then meet informally with each member of the support team to see how they have been able to contribute.

This approach is very successful, however if it is appropriate other family members may be informed of the action that has been taken and the outcome. In rare cases it may be necessary to involve outside agencies such as the Emotional Wellbeing Team or Social Care.

This policy applies irrespective of gender, ethnic background, age, starting point or disability. We understand that we are part of a multicultural society and everyone's contribution is acknowledged.

This policy has been drafted with due consideration to:

- Preventing and Tackling Bullying July 2017
- The School Standards and Framework Act 1998
- Safeguarding Policy
- Child Protection Policy
- The Human Rights Act 1998
- The Employment Equality (Sexual Orientation) Regulations
- The Equality Act/Public Sector Equality Duty
- Every Child Matters
- Relationships and Behaviour Policy
- Trauma Perspective Practice
- DFES Publication – Don't Suffer in Silence (DFEE 64/2000)
- Keeping Children Safe in Education September 2025

This policy will be promoted and implemented throughout the school and will be reviewed by the staff, Headteacher, Governing Body and pupils.

To be reviewed: Autumn 2026